

Documentation

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Chapter 3: four ideas to connect

Purpose of the record

Use the record to support communication, continuity, quality review, reimbursement, and accountability.

EHR and ISBAR

Protect electronic information and organize important communication with a consistent ISBAR structure.

Legal charting standards

Document promptly, objectively, accurately, and completely without assumptions or blame.

Confidentiality

Access only the records needed for your role and correct errors according to policy.

Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

The record should show what happened and how the patient responded.

Chart measurable findings, care provided, the patient's exact statements when relevant, and the response. Never document before care is completed, share passwords, or hide a correction.

- ✓ Use the correct patient record
- ✓ Chart as soon as possible
- ✓ Describe facts—not labels
- ✓ Record the patient response
- ✓ Protect access and passwords

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

Observe the facts.
Chart the care.
Report the change.

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.